

Preconditioning kit install guide

Electroniq Buttons Boutique*
(Dated: June 30, 2026)

This guide walks you through the steps needed to install the head unit preconditioning kit in your 2021-2024 Ioniq 5. See also the [video guides](#):

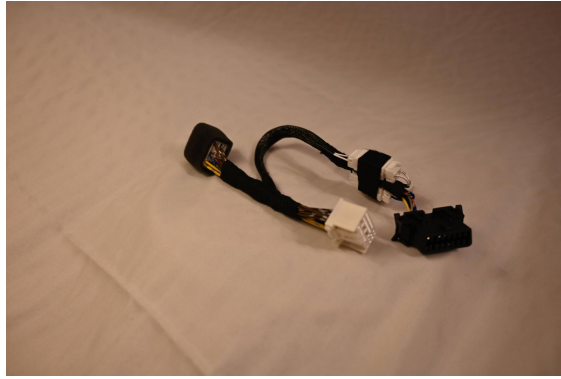
Step 1: Disconnect 12V: video guide: <https://youtu.be/ePBdyeBYKk4>

Step 2: Trim: Option A: long and careful trim video guide: <https://youtu.be/nE4CqGsin7Q>

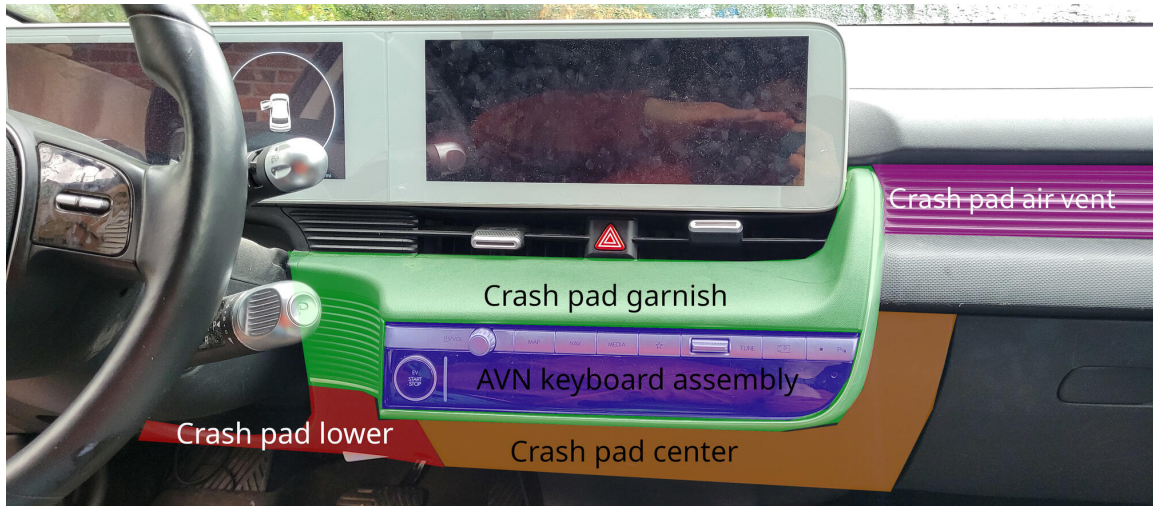
Step 2: Trim: Option B: quick and dirty trim video guide: <https://youtu.be/291boryx-Vc>

Step 3: Harness Connection: video guide: <https://youtu.be/JgrhReAnDGc>

Step 4: OBD Mount: video guide: <https://youtu.be/PqwYul43jFw>



(a)



(b)

Figure 1. (a) Man-in-the-middle harness. (b) Overview of trim panels involved.

I. INTRODUCTION

The purpose of this guide is to illustrate step-by-step instructions for installing the head unit preconditioning kit, or just the head unit man-in-the-middle (MITM) harness, shown in Figure 1a. In section III, we present two options

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for trim removal to access the head unit. In section IV, we describe the process of plugging in the harness. In section V, we show attachment of the OBD port and how to plug in the microcontroller.

Necessary tools:

1. 10mm socket or adjustable wrench for 12V battery (not included)
2. Trim removal tools (included if selected)
3. Phillips #2 allen key (included if selected) or similar

Kit components:

1. Head unit harness
2. WiCAN
3. 70mm OBD mount bracket
4. 70mm double-sided tape (two pieces included for redundancy)
5. 4 zip ties

II. STEP 1: REMOVE 12V NEGATIVE TERMINAL

First, always disconnect the 12V battery before removing any electrical connectors! Removing a live electrical connector could cause a discharge and destroy a connector or ECU in your car.

Step-by-step instructions:

1. Open hood (Figure 2a)
2. Open frunk
3. Remove panel covering 12V (Figure 2b)
4. Loosen nut on negative side with a 10mm socket (Figure 2c)
5. Remove negative terminal (Figure 2d)

III. STEP 2: TRIM

The goal here is to get to the treasure chest: the head unit. The proper way involves removal 4 trim pieces and the AVN keyboard (climate button bar). It's also possible to take a shortcut. The shortcut is much faster but more awkward, with a higher risk of catching a hand on a sharp trim edge. Choose the method that works best for you.

A. Option A: long and careful

Trim panel order of operations:

1. Crash pad lower (Figure 4a)
2. Crash pad air vent (Figure 4b)
3. Crash pad garnish (Figure 4c)
4. AVN keyboard (Figure 4c)
5. Crash pad center (Figure 4c)

Steps 1 and 2 can be done in either order; both must be done to free the crash pad garnish.

Step-by-step instructions:

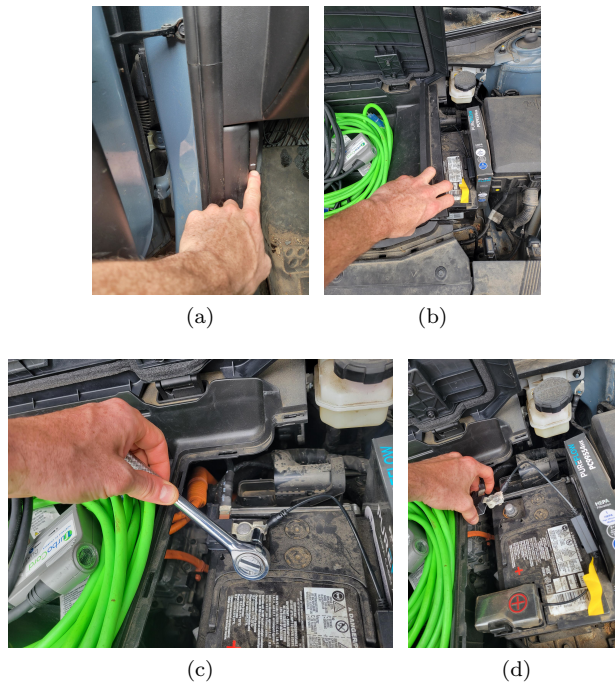


Figure 2. (a) Open the hood. (b) Remove panel covering 12V. (c) Loosen nut on negative terminal. (d) Remove negative terminal.



Figure 3. X marks the head unit.

1. Remove screw in crash pad lower (Figure 5a)
2. Pull off right half of crash pad lower using trim removal tools
3. While here, remove screw(s) behind crash pad lower (may be 1 or 2; see Figure 5b); the leftmost screw attached to the vent behind tends to remain captive, so you have to pull to confirm it's out (Figure 5c)
4. Remove crash pad air vent
5. Remove screw that was hidden behind crash pad air vent (Figure 5d)

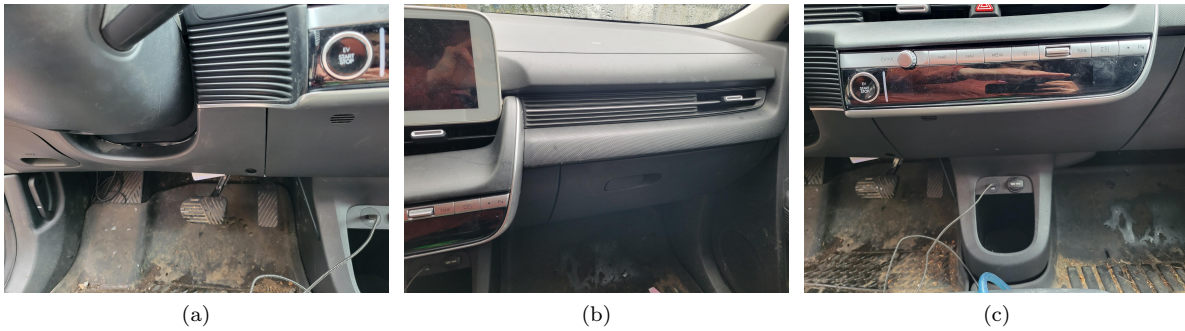


Figure 4. (a) Crash pad lower. (b) Crash pad air vent. (c) Crash pad garnish, AVN keyboard, and crash pad center.

6. Remove crash pad garnish

7. Detach AVN keyboard

- (a) Remove left screw (Figure 5e)
- (b) Remove right screw (Figure 5f)
- (c) Remove lower left screw (Figure 5g)
- (d) Remove lower right screw (Figure 5h)
- (e) (optional, check for no 12V power) Remove all electrical connectors from rear of AVN keyboard
- (f) Disconnect trim clips by pulling outwards on the keyboard (Figure 5i)
- (g) If electrical connectors are still connected, avoid putting too much tension on them

8. Remove crash pad center upper right screw that was blocked by AVN keyboard (Figure 5j)

9. (optional) Re-insert AVN keyboard for safekeeping if electrical connectors are still attached

10. Remove crash pad center upper left screw (Figure 5k)

11. Remove crash pad center trim panel using trim removal tools

12. (check for no 12V power first) Disconnect electrical connector from back of panel and move it away from work area

B. Option B: quick and dirty

We only partially remove two trim panels with this approach:

- 1. Crash pad lower
- 2. Crash pad center

Note that crash pad garnish may still come loose during installation. It can be popped back on when done.
Step-by-step instructions:

- 1. Remove screw in crash pad lower (Figure 5a)
- 2. Pull off right half of crash pad lower using trim removal tool
- 3. While here, remove screw(s) behind crash pad lower (may be 1 or 2; see Figure 5b); the leftmost screw attached to the vent behind tends to remain captive, so you have to pull to confirm it's out (Figure 5c)
- 4. Pull out the bottom of crash pad center
- 5. You can now access the head unit from underneath crash pad center



Figure 5. (a) Removing screw in crash pad lower. (b) You may find one or two screws behind crash pad lower. (c) Removing screw(s) behind crash pad lower. (d) Removing screw holding in crash pad garnish. (e) Removing AVN keyboard left screw. (f) Removing AVN keyboard right screw. (g) Removing AVN keyboard lower left screw. (h) Removing AVN keyboard lower right screw. (i) Removing AVN keyboard. (j) Removing crash pad center screw that was blocked by AVN keyboard. (k) Removing crash pad center screw that was behind crash pad garnish, left of the AVN keyboard.

IV. STEP 3: HARNESS CONNECTION

This step covers the installation of the harness into the head unit.
Step-by-step instructions:

1. Identify original grey female head unit connector (Figure 6c)
2. Remove it by squeezing the clip and pulling down (Figure 6d)
3. Insert the harness female side into the head unit (Figure 6a)
4. Insert the female connector you removed into the harness male side (Figure 6e)

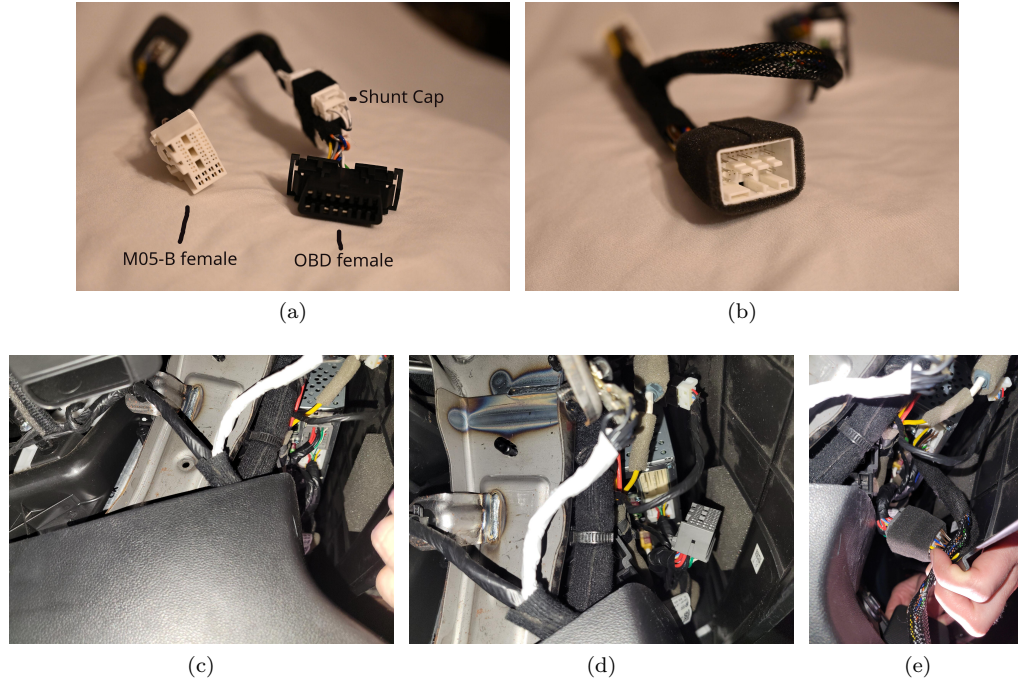


Figure 6. (a) Labeled photo showing female harness connector. (b) Male harness connector. (c) Head unit with connectors plugged in. (d) Female M05-B connector (grey) removed from head unit. (e) Harness installed in head unit.

V. STEP 4: OBD MOUNT

In this step, we mount the OBD end of the harness securely and plug in the WiCAN.
Step-by-step instructions:

1. Thread harness along the bottom edge of crash pad lower
2. Plug OBD female into bracket
3. Use double-sided tape to mount bracket to inside of crash pad lower
4. Use zip ties to attach harness to other wires and mount points (Figure 7a)
5. While holding bracket, plug in WiCAN (Figure 7b)

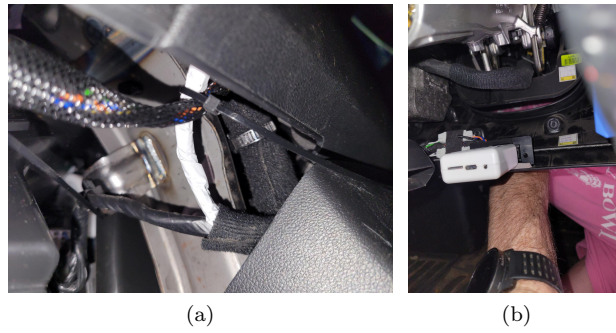


Figure 7. (a) Harness zip-tied to existing wire. (b) WiCAN inserted into OBD.

VI. STEP 5: CLEAN UP

Reverse the trim removal steps. Make sure trim clips are aligned, and then firmly pop the trim panels back into place. Reconnect 12V battery negative terminal. The WiCAN should immediately show a blue light. Change your WiCAN password: <https://meatpihq.github.io/wican-fw/config/wifi>. You can connect you your WiCAN directly by finding a WiFi network named 'WiCAN_xxxxxxx' and going to <http://192.168.80.1/> in your browser.